PASS & PLAY · HOUSE RULES SCROLL

The Tavern Contract

Three rounds. Five contracts on the board. Everyone at this table has a secret reason to be here. One phone, no sound, roughly twelve minutes.

2–6	3	~12	8
players, one phone	rounds of deals	minutes per game	secret roles

The premise

You are all regulars of the same disreputable tavern, hustling for work off a public contract board. Each contract pays points — but every player is secretly chasing a private objective that may have very little to do with winning the contracts themselves. Claim loudly, sabotage quietly, and never explain yourself until the tally at the end.

What you need

- One shared phone or tablet running the game — it gets passed around the table.
- 2 to 6 players, ideally with drinks in hand.
- Optionally, a turn timer (30 or 60 seconds) chosen at setup.

The four resources

Every player starts the game with **one of each**.



Gold

Coin. Grease. The thing guards and nobles both want.



Mana

Raw magic for the jobs steel can't talk its way through.



Steel

Blades and blunt instruments. Charged by the bruise.



Ink

Ledgers, forgeries and finely-worded threats.

Setup

1. Choose the number of players and enter everyone's name.
2. Pick a turn timer — 30 seconds, 60 seconds, or none.
3. Tap **Deal the secret roles**. Five contracts are laid on the board, and the rest form the deck.
4. Pass the phone around: each player taps to reveal their secret role, reads it, then hides it and passes on. *Everyone else: look at your drink.*

Your turn: three choices

On your turn the phone is yours and the board shows five contracts. Each contract lists its point value and two resources it costs. You may do exactly one of the following:

CLAIM

Spend the two resources shown and take the contract's points. Before you claim, the phone asks you to **pitch it out loud**: one sentence to the table explaining how you're using those two resources to pull this off. No pitch, no contract. Afterward a fresh contract is drawn from the deck to refill the board.

SABOTAGE

Knock a contract off the board so nobody can have it. You don't pay anything for this — but a random mishap immediately befalls the **next player** in order: they lose a resource or a point (see the penalty table below). The sabotaged contract is replaced from the deck. Sabotage costs you your whole turn.

PASS & COLLECT

Skip the board and gather supplies. Pick any two resources — they may be two of the same kind — and add them to your stash. The safest move at the table, and certain quiet roles depend on it.

If the timer runs out

If you chose a turn timer at setup and time expires before you act, the tavern decides for you: you lose your turn and collect two random resources, exactly as if you had passed.

Sabotage penalties

When someone sabotages, the **next player in order** suffers one of these, drawn at random:

- The guard fines you 1 gold. *(lose 1 Gold)*
- Your reagents spoil: lose 1 mana. *(lose 1 Mana)*
- A blade snaps: lose 1 steel. *(lose 1 Steel)*
- Your ledger is seized: lose 1 ink. *(lose 1 Ink)*
- A rumour costs you 1 point of standing. *(lose 1 point)*

Rounds and flow

- The game lasts **three rounds**. In each round, every player takes exactly one turn, in seating order.
- Between turns the phone shows a handoff screen — pass it to the named player. Any penalty from the last sabotage is announced there, in public.
- The board always shows five contracts; claimed and sabotaged contracts are immediately replaced from the deck.

The eight secret roles

Each player is dealt one role at random. Its bonus is added to your contract points at the end. With fewer than eight players, some roles stay hidden in the deck — nobody knows which.

Role	Who you are	Secret objective
The Poisoner	*You keep a vial for every occasion.*	+3 points for every contract you sabotage.
The Guildmaster	*Paperwork is a weapon.*	+2 points for every contract you claim after the first.
The Smuggler	*Everything arrives. Eventually. For a fee.*	+1 point per 2 unspent resources at the end of the game.
The Rogue Scholar	*You read the contract's footnotes. Twice.*	+4 points if you claim at least one contract worth 5 or more.
The Alchemist	*Mana is just gold that hasn't settled down.*	+2 points for each claimed contract that required Mana.
The Sellsword	*You charge by the bruise.*	+2 points for each claimed contract that required Steel.
The Fence	*You never own anything for long.*	+5 points if you pass at least twice.
The Chronicler	*The tale matters more than the coin.*	+1 point per claimed contract of every other kind of resource you used.

Scoring

- **Contract points** — the printed value of every contract you claimed during the game.
- **Secret bonus** — your role's objective, tallied once the final turn ends. Roles are revealed to everyone at the tally.
- **Highest total wins.** The tavern raises a glass to the winner — and a reputation nobody can quite verify.

Highest total takes the night.

A loud claimer with no secret plan loses to a quiet passer with a good one, more often than you'd think.

Table etiquette

- **Guard the phone.** Only the named player reads their role screen; everyone else studies their drink.
- **Pitch with a straight face.** One sentence, out loud, every claim. Half the game is the acting.
- **Sabotage in silence.** There's no table talk about who wrecked what — the log keeps the receipts until the end.
- **Trust no one's explanation** of their own scoring — the tally reveals every role and bonus.